

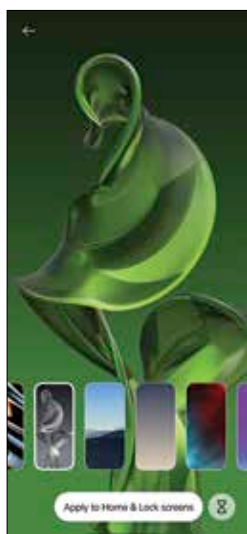
separation. This also kind of continues the rounded “pebble” theme as seen on icons and widgets. Sometimes though, the rounded-boxy card interface minimised how much information could be placed. If the corners of the cards were tightened up a bit more, there would be more space to fit in additional information or more notifications on a single screen.

Nevertheless, we quite enjoyed the revamped look of ColorOS 13. It looks a lot more classy, fluid, and simple. Although it's not quite as simple and minimalist as Stock Android or even One UI, this is a step in the right direction.

HOME SCREEN AND CONTROL CENTRE

The newly-designed app icons, that we spoke about above, are meant to be more recognisable and readable – even for people with visual impairments, according to Oppo. While we wouldn't go that far, we can definitely say that the contrast has been upped to make icons more recognisable. Also, the new ‘Oppo Sans’ font looks great with the Aquamorphic theme.

Oppo has also added a new type of folder to the home screen called Enlarged Folders. These folders eliminate the step of having to tap on the folder and then click on the app you're looking for. Instead, these folders are 2x2 folders that house app icons (without the names) that can be tapped on to directly open them – no extra steps required. You can also swipe within the folder to access more apps. We found these enlarged folders quite nifty, but since they eliminate the app's name, you should use these with easily recognisable app icons to avoid confusion. Oppo drew inspiration from iOS here and that's clear, but it's still nifty nonetheless.



New Blossom Wallpaper

ColorOS also comes with a Shelf that's very similar to OnePlus' Shelf. You can pull down anywhere on the screen to access it. There is not a lot you can do with the Shelf at the moment except add some custom widgets and Spotify integration.

The Control Centre has been redesigned as well. The top part of the Control Centre houses two large toggles on the left and a media playback widget on the right. These toggles alongside the top five tiles are available even if you swipe down the notification bar just once, making them easy to access. The names of the small tiles are omitted when you swipe down once, but when you swipe down again to open the expanded control panel, the names appear. This helps keep things uncluttered and clean.

Another nice touch is the changes in the Control Panel or Centre in landscape mode. The Control Panel and Notifications Bar take up the whole screen in landscape mode now which looks much better compared to the panel with tons of empty space on the sides in ColorOS 12. Additionally, the Control Centre moves to the left while

the Notifications Panel is situated on the right in landscape mode which makes it slightly easier to respond to notifications without having to scroll too far down.

ALWAYS-ON DISPLAY

Oppo has revamped its Always-On Display as well. Users can access and control Spotify and show relevant information from food delivery apps such as Zomato and Swiggy, all without unlocking the screen. We used the Spotify integration and found it to

be a bit buggy, double-tapping to access the music controls menu would take a bit too long to show up. Hopefully, this gets fixed when the OS is out of Beta.

Food delivery apps' integration is pretty great. The screen displays information such as “Order accepted”, “Meal Picked Up”, the distance to the destination, and more, so you don't have to constantly check these apps to know where your food has reached.

Oppo has also added extra Always-On animations featuring animals and nature. One wallpaper depicts changes in animals' homes due to temperature changes based on the daily temperature change in your area. It's a pretty cool concept, albeit a bit gimmicky. There's also an Insight Always-On display that tracks the user's number of phone unlocks in a day. There's a coloured line running across



Control Centre on ColorOS 13 (left) vs Control Centre on ColorOS 12 (right)

the screen and every time you unlock the phone and spend time on time, it creates a little dink or groove in the line.

Lastly, Oppo has continued on Bitmoji integration with ColorOS 13. You can display your own Bitmoji on the Always-On Display in various states such as working, listening to music, eating, and more. We personally don't see ourselves using this feature much and find it a bit unnecessary but some users may enjoy it.

All in all, Oppo has expanded the use cases of its Always-On display adding some meaningful features such as Spotify, Zomato and Swiggy integration. However, we really hope Oppo adds sup-



Home Screen with Enlarged Folders